# PLATO AND ARISTOTLE — IDEAS, SUBSTANCE, FORM AND MATTER, CAUSATION, ACTUALITY AND POTENTIALITY

ONE QUESTION -> WHAT A FORM IS -> SUN, LINE, CAVE -> PARTICIPATION UNDER PRESSURE -> ARISTOTLE'S CRITIQUE AND IMMANENT REPAIR -> SUBSTANCE -> HYLOMORPHISM -> FOUR CAUSES -> POTENCY TO ACT -> COMPARISON AND ANSWER SPINE

Follow the cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis. Every stage uses a layout chosen for its own content: root-branch for problems, a timeline for chronology and for the potency-act ladder, matrices for the Divided Line and for substance, a process band for the Cave and for the four causes, a dialectic panel for participation under pressure, and paired columns for evidence boundaries. The grey E card is optional enrichment and never repairs a missing core point.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE - pending user review - repaired in place with all prior artifacts unchanged outside this topic

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

## STAGE 00 THE ONE QUESTION BOTH MEN ANSWER

- ONE-MANY (hen epi pollon)
- KNOWLEDGE NEEDS A STABLE OBJECT
- OBJECTIVITY OF VALUE
- PLATO: SEPARATE THE CHARACTER
- ARISTOTLE: KEEP IT INSIDE THE THING
- SYLLABUS: IDEAS; SUBSTANCE; FORM AND MATTER
- CAUSATION; ACTUALITY AND POTENTIALITY
- 12 OWNED PYQ PARTS, EVERY YEAR 2018-2025

**HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER?**

**PLATO: separate the character from the thing - transcendent Form (eidos), particulars participate (methexis) or imitate (mimesis)** → **ARISTOTLE: keep the character inside the thing - immanent essence (to ti en einai) in a matter-form compound** → **COST EACH SIDE PAYS: separation leaves participation unanalysed; immanence inherits the problem of universals**

### THE THREE PROBLEMS ONE POSIT MUST SOLVE

- Unity of the many: many just acts, one intelligible standard of Justice
- Possibility of knowledge (episteme) when sensibles are in flux
- Objectivity of value: what makes 'beautiful' or 'good' more than opinion

### PRINTED CLAUSE AND CORPUS SIGNAL

- Syllabus, verbatim: Ideas; Substance; Form and Matter; Causation; Actuality and Potentiality
- 12 primary-owned parts of 112 Western parts; at least one part in every year 2018-2025
- Nine of the twelve are 10-mark parts, so compression discipline decides the score

### MEMORY IMAGE AND SCOPE CONTROL

- Plato points UP, away from the thing; Aristotle points HERE, into it
- Answer the printed metaphysics: soul, ethics, politics and logic are cross-links, not owner content
- Three licensed exceptions only: recollection as an argument for Forms, the Cave's own return, the soul as form of the body

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Both philosophers face one question about the character of things, and every later disagreement between them is a consequence of the single answer each gives to it.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Plato and Aristotle answer one question about how many changing things share a knowable character, and their whole dispute turns on whether that character exists apart from the things themselves.**

01

## STAGE 01 ORIGIN, CHRONOLOGY AND THE TEXTUAL MAP

- ACADEMY c.387 BCE
- ARISTOTLE INSIDE THE ACADEMY ~20 YEARS
- LYCEUM c.335 BCE
- MIDDLE DIALOGUES: MENO, PHAEDO, REPUBLIC
- LATE DIALOGUES: PARMENIDES, SOPHIST, TIMAEUS
- CHRONOLOGY IS DISPUTED

**SOCRATES c.470-399 BCE: 'what is F itself?' - the search for definitions** → **PLATO c.428-348 BCE, Academy c.387 BCE: middle dialogues give recollection, Forms, knowledge and opinion, Sun, Line, Cave** → **LATE PLATO: Parmenides states the participation dilemma and the regress against his own theory; Sophist and Timaeus revise rather than abandon** → **ARISTOTLE c.384-322 BCE enters the Academy c.367 BCE and stays about twenty years, then founds the Lyceum c.335 BCE** → **ARISTOTLE'S TREATISES: Categories (predication), Physics I-III (change, causes), Metaphysics I (critique), Z-H (substance), Theta (potency-act), Lambda (the mover), De Anima II.1 (soul as form)**

### WHY THE SEQUENCE MATTERS

- The critique in Metaphysics I.9 and XIII.4-5 is an internal demolition of a teacher's system, not an attack from a rival school
- The Parmenides objections are Plato's own, so the theory was already under pressure before Aristotle wrote against it

### ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

- Dialogue chronology and developmental readings are disputed; attribute an argument to its dialogue
- Do not write that every Platonic dialogue teaches one unchanged two-world theory
- Aristotle's 'substance' answers different questions in the Categories and the Metaphysics

### TEXTUAL OWNERSHIP AT A GLANCE

- Meno and Phaedo: recollection, equality, motivations for Forms
- Republic V-VII: knowledge and opinion, the Good, Sun, Line, Cave, dialectic
- Timaeus: Demiurge and Receptacle, a likely account of cosmology, not the Republic's Good

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Aristotle's metaphysics is a reply produced from inside Plato's own school, which is why it keeps the vocabulary while reversing the ontology.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Because Aristotle spent about twenty years inside the Academy, his critique should be presented as an internal correction of Plato rather than as an external refutation.**

02

## STAGE 02 WHAT A FORM IS - FIVE PROPERTIES AND TWO LEVELS

- ETERNAL
- IMMUTABLE
- NON-MATERIAL
- SELF-IDENTICAL
- SEPARATE
- THE GOOD IS BEYOND BEING (509b)
- NOT A PLACE, NOT A CONCEPT

**FORM (eidos, idea): the Beautiful itself, not any beautiful thing, but that by virtue of which beautiful things are beautiful**

**INTELLIGIBLE LEVEL: eternal, grasped by reason (nous), the truly real (ontos on), object of knowledge (episteme)** → **SENSIBLE LEVEL: temporal, in flux, taken by opinion (doxa), derivative reality - copies, not illusions** → **APEX: the Good gives the other Forms both their being and their knowability, as the sun gives visible things growth and visibility**

### EACH PROPERTY DOES A JOB

- Eternal and immutable: only what cannot be otherwise can be known
- Non-material: one Form must serve indefinitely many instances
- Self-identical: sensibles are F and not-F in different relations; the F itself never is
- Separate: the standard must not depend on what it corrects

### TIMELESS AND SPACELESS - THE 2025 DEMAND

- Spaceless: no magnitude, shape or position - the Form of Justice is not 'somewhere'
- Timeless: no generation, destruction or alteration; timeless is not the same as everlasting
- Hence knowable but not perceivable: elucidate means derive this, not assert it

### TWO CAUTIONS THAT COST MARKS

- 'Intelligible realm' is structural language, not a second physical location
- Forms are not concepts in minds - that is conceptualism, which Plato rejects
- Plato grants the sensible world derivative reality; he is not an illusionist

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The five properties are not a list of adjectives but a set of jobs, and the 2025 question is answered by deriving spacelessness and timelessness from them.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Because a Form is non-material and self-identical it can occupy no position and undergo no alteration, and it is exactly that double negation which makes it an object of knowledge rather than of opinion.**

03

## STAGE 03 WHY FORMS ARE POSITED - THE FOUR ARGUMENTS

- ONE-OVER-MANY
- ARGUMENT FROM KNOWLEDGE
- COMPRESENCE OF OPPOSITES
- RECOLLECTION (anamnesis)
- REPUBLIC V; PARMENIDES 132a
- PHAEDO 74a-75d; 72e-77a; MENO 80d-86c
- RECOLLECTION IS ONE ROUTE, NOT THE WHOLE

### THE TWO LOAD-BEARING ARGUMENTS

- One-over-many (hen epi pollon): a common predicate applied to many requires one thing they share - Republic V, Parmenides 132a
- From knowledge: knowledge requires an unchanging object, the sensible world is in flux, so its objects are non-sensible universals - Republic V-VII

### THE TWO SUPPORTING ARGUMENTS

- Opposites and relativity: a stick is longer than X and shorter than Y, but the Large itself is never small - Phaedo 74a-75d
- Recollection (anamnesis): we judge sensibles as falling short of a perfection never met in sense - Phaedo 72e-77a, Meno 80d-86c

### SCOPE AND TRAP CONTROL

- Recollection is one supporting route, not Plato's complete epistemology; the Republic adds the dialectical ascent
- The soul enters here only as an argument for the Forms; the tripartite soul, justice and the philosopher-ruler are not owner content
- Forms are posited to explain stability and intelligibility despite change - explaining change is Aristotle's project

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The unity premise and the stability premise converge on the same posit, so one theory discharges two explanatory debts at once.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Forms are introduced to solve unity, knowledge and value together, and the theory should be judged by whether any rival account solves all three at once.**

04

## STAGE 04 THE DIVIDED LINE - FOUR STATES, FOUR OBJECTS, ONE SCALE

- EIKASIA
- PISTIS
- DIANOIA
- NOESIS
- PRIMARY CUT: DOXA vs EPISTEME
- METHOD, NOT DIFFICULTY
- REPUBLIC VI 509d-511e

| SEGMENT | STATE OF MIND | OBJECTS | METHOD |
|---|---|---|---|
| A (highest) | Noesis - intellection (nous) | The Forms, culminating in the Good | Dialectic: treats hypotheses as steps up to an unhypothetical first principle (arche anhypothetos), then descends using no images |
| B | Dianoia - thought | Mathematical objects | Uses visible things as images; argues downward from hypotheses it takes as known and gives no account of |
| C | Pistis - belief | Visible things: creatures, plants, artefacts | Ordinary perception and trust |
| D (lowest) | Eikasia - conjecture | Images: shadows and reflections (eikones) | Taking images for their originals |

### THE CUTS AND THE MNEMONIC

- Primary cut: D plus C is opinion (doxa); B plus A is knowledge (episteme)
- Mnemonic E-P-D-N matched to Images, Things, Mathematicals, Forms
- The Sun analogy grounds the scale: the Good gives Forms knowability and being (Republic VI 507a-509c)

### THE DISCRIMINATOR THAT DECIDES THE MARKS

- Dianoia and noesis differ by direction of argument and use of images, not by difficulty of subject matter
- A hard theorem is still dianoia; an elementary piece of dialectic is still noesis

### OBJECTION AND SCHOLARLY ASIDE

- Objection: 'more real' is not a coherent comparative; Aristotle denies degrees of being at Metaphysics I.9
- Reply: 'more real' means more self-identically and unqualifiedly what it is
- Contested aside: Plato's own instruction makes the middle segments C and B necessarily equal in length

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The Line is one scale read twice, so that degrees of clarity in the knower correspond exactly to degrees of being in the known.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: What separates thought from intellection in the Divided Line is the direction of argument and the use of images, not the difficulty of the subject matter.**

05

## STAGE 05 THE CAVE - ASCENT, CONVERSION AND THE COMPELLED RETURN

- SHADOWS -> EIKASIA
- FIRE AND ARTEFACTS -> PISTIS
- REFLECTIONS -> DIANOIA
- THE SUN -> NOESIS AND THE GOOD
- PERIAGOGE: TURNING THE WHOLE SOUL
- KATABASIS: THE COMPELLED RETURN
- POPPER 1945 ATTACKS THE LAST STEP

**Prisoners chained from childhood see only shadows cast by a fire behind them - eikasia** → **One is released, turns, and sees the fire and the carried artefacts that cast the shadows - pistis** → **Dragged up the rough ascent, he bears at first only shadows and reflections in water - dianoia** → **Then the things themselves, then the stars, finally the Sun, and he infers that it governs all that is visible - noesis, culminating in the Good** → **He must go back down, will see badly in the dark, will be ridiculed and may be killed - the Socrates allusion**

### WHAT THE CAVE ADDS TO THE LINE

- Pain and compulsion: education (paideia) turns an organ of vision the soul already possesses
- Conversion (periagoge) of the whole soul, not the insertion of knowledge into an empty one
- The return (katabasis): the ascent creates an obligation, and Plato instructs at 517a-b that the image be applied as a whole

### PRESUPPOSITIONS OF THE TRIAD

- Degrees of reality correlate with degrees of cognitive clarity
- The object determines the faculty - Republic V 476e-480a
- There is an unhypothetical first principle, or the ascent has no terminus
- The soul already possesses the capacity for noesis, hence recollection

### THE WEAKEST LINK

- The step from having seen the Good to being entitled to rule does not follow by itself
- Popper attacks exactly here in The Open Society and Its Enemies, Volume I (1945)
- Popper's reading is widely regarded as polemical and is contested by Plato scholars

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Because knowledge is a conversion of the whole soul rather than a transfer of information, an account of cognition turns into an argument about who may rule.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cave proves three things at once: that clarity tracks reality, that education is conversion rather than transmission, and that the one who has seen the Good must return.**

06

## STAGE 06 PARTICIPATION UNDER PRESSURE - DILEMMA, REGRESS, IMPOTENCE

- METHEXIS AND MIMESIS
- WHOLE OR PART - PARMENIDES 131a-c
- SELF-PREDICATION
- NON-IDENTITY
- THIRD MAN - PARMENIDES 132a-b
- CAUSAL IMPOTENCE SURVIVES EVERY ESCAPE
- NAME COMES FROM ARISTOTLE'S REPORTS

### OBJECTION 1 - THE PARTICIPATION DILEMMA

- Whole Form in each participant? Then it is separated from itself
- Only a part in each? Then a divided Form of Smallness would make its participant large
- Reply available: the dilemma assumes Forms behave like extended bodies, and a spaceless entity does not

### OBJECTION 2 - THE REGRESS

- Premise 1, self-predication: the Form of F is itself F
- Premise 2, non-identity: the explaining Form must differ from what it explains
- A further Form follows at every stage; escape route is to deny self-predication
- The argument is Plato's at Parmenides 132a-b; the name comes from Aristotle's reports at 990b17 and 1039a2

### OBJECTION 3 - THE ONE THAT SURVIVES

- A changeless, non-spatial, separated Form cannot be an efficient cause of change
- Participation and imitation remain metaphors without a causal mechanism
- Multiple participation is possible: the red chair is a chair through Chairness and red through Redness, and neither becomes a part of it

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Blocking self-predication saves the theory from the regress alone, because the explanatory gap between a separated Form and its participant remains unclosed.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The relation between Idea and world is not demonstrably inconsistent, but it is explanatorily empty, because a relation that cannot be specified cannot do explanatory work.**

07

## STAGE 07 PLATO'S CAUSAL REPERTOIRE - AND THE ACCURATE OBJECTION

- PHAEDO: FORMAL EXPLANATION
- REPUBLIC: THE GOOD GROUNDS BEING
- TIMAEUS: THE DEMIURGE ORDERS
- TIMAEUS: THE RECEPTACLE (chora)
- THE GOOD IS NOT THE DEMIURGE
- CHORA IS NOT ARISTOTELIAN MATTER
- SAY: SEPARATED FORMS THEMSELVES

### WHAT EACH DIALOGUE SUPPLIES

- Phaedo: a thing is beautiful because of Beauty and equal because of Equality - formal explanation without a mechanism of motion
- Republic: the Good grounds being and intelligibility and supplies an ultimate normative orientation
- Timaeus: a Demiurge orders becoming by looking to Forms as paradigms, and a Receptacle is the third kind in which becoming appears

### THE LIMITS THAT MUST BE STATED

- The Demiurge crafts order and does not create the Forms or the Receptacle from nothing
- The Good is not simply a personal creator-God, and its relation to the Demiurge is contested
- The Receptacle is not straightforwardly identical with Aristotle's matter

### HOW TO PHRASE THE OBJECTION

- Wrong and easily rebutted: 'Plato has no causes at all'
- Right and hard to rebut: separated Forms themselves explain neither motion, generation nor internal organisation
- The Timaeus pays the explanatory debt with a new entity rather than with an analysis of participation

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Plato has more explanatory resources than Aristotle's summary allows, so the charge must be aimed precisely at what separated Forms cannot do.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's decisive complaint is not that Plato names no other cause but that separated Forms by themselves explain neither motion nor the organisation of a substance.**

08

## STAGE 08 ARISTOTLE'S FIVE OBJECTIONS AND THE IMMANENT REPAIR

- THIRD MAN REGRESS
- DUPLICATION
- PARTICIPATION IS A METAPHOR
- CAUSAL IMPOTENCE
- NO ACCOUNT OF GENERATION
- KEEP THE EIDOS, DELETE THE SEPARATION
- Z.13 IS THE PRICE

**METAPHYSICS I.9 AND XIII.4-5: five objections, of which only the regress needs self-predication**

**STACE'S REPORT: the Ideas are 'nothing but eternalized things of nature', and the theory places the essences outside the things themselves** → **THE REPAIR: form becomes the immanent what-it-is-to-be (to ti en einai) of this concrete composite** → **RETAINED: species and genus as secondary substances. DELETED: separate existence and the priority of the universal**

### WHAT THE REPAIR BUYS

- No regress: with no separation the Form-particular resemblance never arises
- Real causation: an immanent form is the actuality that the matter is potentially
- Generation explained: matter can lose one form and acquire another
- Unity: the composite is one thing, not two things joined

### WHAT THE REPAIR COSTS

- Form must be intelligible and hence in some sense universal, yet Metaphysics VII (Z).13 denies that any universal is a substance
- Whether form is individual in each substance or species-level remains contested
- Prime matter, needed for radical generation, is a limiting posit whose textual standing is disputed

### PRECISION THAT EARNS MARKS

- Never 'Aristotle rejected the Forms' - he rejects separated Forms and the priority of the universal
- Never 'Aristotle denies universals' - species and genus survive as secondary substances
- Objections two to five do not need self-predication, so the explanatory gap survives every escape route

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Aristotle defeats separation rather than form, so Plato's motivating insight is answered rather than refuted and the difficulty simply changes address.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle keeps intelligible form and drops only its separation, converting a paradigm that could not cause anything into a principle that constitutes the thing it explains.**

09

## STAGE 09 SUBSTANCE - TWO QUESTIONS, FOUR CANDIDATES, ONE VERDICT

- PRIMARY SUBSTANCE (tode ti)
- SECONDARY SUBSTANCE
- ESSENCE (to ti en einai)
- Z.3 REJECTS BARE MATTER
- Z.13: NO UNIVERSAL IS A SUBSTANCE
- Z.17: WHY IS THIS MATTER A HOUSE?
- TEN CATEGORIES ARE MODES OF PREDICATION

| QUESTION | CATEGORIES 2a11 ff. | METAPHYSICS VII (Z) |
|---|---|---|
| What is being asked | Which things are substances? | What is the substance of a thing? |
| Criterion used | Logical-linguistic: the ultimate subject of predication | Causal-explanatory: what makes it be what it is |
| Answer given | The concrete individual (tode ti): this man, this horse | The form or essence (to ti en einai) |
| Status of the species | Secondary substance, less real than the individual | Essence is prior in being, definition and knowledge |
| Status of matter | Not discussed | Rejected at Z.3: neither separable nor a 'this' |
| The sting | Everything else is said of, or is in, a primary substance | Z.13 denies substancehood to any universal, yet form looks universal |

### Z.3 CANDIDATES AND VERDICTS

- Substratum as matter: rejected - what survives the removal of all predicates is not a 'this'
- Essence: accepted, the leading answer of Z.4-6 and Z.17
- Universal: rejected at Z.13. Genus: rejected, since a genus is predicated of many

### FOUR READINGS - NAME AT LEAST TWO

- Different questions, therefore different answers - the safest exam line
- Developmentalist (Jaeger), depending on a disputed chronology
- Individual forms (Frede-Patzig) and species forms (Owen) - both contested

### SUBSTANCE AND ACCIDENT

- Ten categories: substance, quantity, quality, relation, place, time, position, state, action, being affected
- Substance is; accidents belong to substance. Alteration is accidental change, generation is substantial
- The categories classify modes of predication and being, not physical components

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The Categories identifies the substances while the Metaphysics identifies substance-hood, so a change of answer follows a change of question rather than a change of mind.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The individual remains what exists in the primary way, but what accounts for its being the individual it is, is its form - and Aristotle denies that substance has a single sense.**

10

## STAGE 10 HYLOMORPHISM - MATTER, FORM, PRIVATION, PRIME MATTER

- MATTER (hyle) IS RELATIVE
- FORM (morphe) MAKES IT ONE
- COMPOUND (synolon)
- PRIVATION (steresis)
- SOUL AS FORM OF THE LIVING BODY
- PRIME MATTER IS A LIMIT CONCEPT
- 2025 BOUNDARY ON 'EVERYTHING'

**EVERY SENSIBLE NATURAL SUBSTANCE IS MATTER INFORMED BY FORM - a compound (synolon), not two objects joined**

**MATTER IS RELATIVE: copper and tin become bronze, bronze becomes the statue; there is no bottom layer without arrangement** → **CHANGE = underlying subject + acquired form + prior privation; the unmusical man persists, acquires musicality, loses the privation** → **ACCIDENTAL CHANGE keeps the substantial form; SUBSTANTIAL GENERATION installs a new one and a new substance exists**

### THREE JOBS, THREE TOOLS

- Matter, form and privation give the structure of change
- Potentiality and actuality give the modal transition
- The four causes give the reason why this determinate process occurs

### PRIME MATTER, HANDLED SAFELY

- A limiting posit of matter considered without any determinate form, never existing independently
- Criticism: an unintelligible abstraction. Reply: a limit concept required by radical generation
- Do not present it as an observed stuff, and do not equate it with the Receptacle

### THE 2025 QUANTIFIER AND ITS LIMITS

- The claim holds of sensible substances, where the soul is the form of the living body (De Anima II.1)
- It does not extend to accidents considered apart from their subject
- Nor to mathematical abstractions, nor to the Unmoved Mover, which is pure form without matter

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** One pair of correlative principles explains unity, change, persistence and definition, which is why physics, biology and psychology form a single enquiry for Aristotle.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Matter and form are not two things joined but two correlative principles of one substance, and that is what dissolves the two-world problem without abandoning essence.**

11

## STAGE 11 FOUR CAUSES AND INTERNAL TELEOLOGY

- MATERIAL: MADE OF WHAT?
- FORMAL: WHAT IS IT?
- EFFICIENT: BY WHAT?
- FINAL: FOR WHAT?
- ALL FOUR OPERATE SIMULTANEOUSLY
- DIRECTEDNESS, NOT DESIGN
- MILL EXCLUDES FINAL CAUSES BY DEFINITION

**STATUE: bronze, the shape of Hermes, the sculptor, to honour the god - the artefact is a teaching case where intention really is present** → **ACORN: acorn matter, oak-form, parent and nutrition, the mature oak - in organisms formal, efficient and final causes converge** → **DEVELOPMENTAL CHANGE: matter supplies the potential, an efficient cause initiates, a telos directs, a formal cause specifies what it becomes** → **IDENTITY AS PROCESS: the same substantial form states what the thing is and is the actuality its potential moves toward**

### WHAT 'CAUSE' MEANS HERE

- Aristotelian causation includes reasons as well as causes - Stace records that all four operate simultaneously in every production
- Mill's cause as the invariable and unconditional antecedent excludes final causes at once
- The four are aspects of one explanation, never four events and never four agents

### TELEOLOGY DEFENDED AND LIMITED

- 'Nature does nothing in vain' - De Caelo, Politics, De Partibus Animalium - asserts regularity, not deliberation
- The acorn reliably becomes an oak and never a cat; that reliability is what the final cause names
- Decisive against teleology in physics; functional explanation survives in biology as adaptation and organ-function

### OBJECTION AND REPLY ON IDENTITY

- Objection: defining a process by its completed form reads the end back into the beginning
- Reply: a potentiality is a capacity of this material under these conditions, not a guarantee of completion
- Verdict: consonant, but the consonance is purchased with internal teleology

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The four causes are four complementary answers to one question about one thing, which is why an explanation giving only the efficient cause is for Aristotle incomplete.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's reasons for developmental change are the four causes working together, so that change is the actualisation of matter's potentiality under the direction of a final cause.**

12

## STAGE 12 POTENCY TO ACT - CHANGE, PRIORITY AND PURE ACTUALITY

- DYNAMIS
- KINESIS
- ENERGEIA / ENTELECHEIA
- PHYSICS III.1 (201a10)
- BEING-IN-POTENTIALITY
- PRIORITY IS NOT TEMPORAL
- UNMOVED MOVER MOVES AS FINAL CAUSE

**BLOCK OF WOOD: the capacity to become a table - dynamis, an ontological capacity and never a probability** → **THE CARPENTER WORKING: the actuality of the potential precisely as potential - kinesis, Physics III.1, 201a10** → **THE FINISHED TABLE: the capacity fulfilled - energeia as activity, entelecheia as completed state** → **PARMENIDES AND HERACLITUS BOTH ANSWERED: a third status, being-in-potentiality, denies their shared dichotomy** → **TERMINUS: the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality, moving as the beloved moves the lover - Metaphysics XII (Lambda).7**

### PRIORITY OF ACTUALITY IN THREE SENSES

- In definition: 'potentially F' presupposes what it is actually to be F - hence potentiality is indefinable
- In time at species level: only an actual oak produces acorns
- In substance: the end is what the becoming is for
- Concede openly that in an individual's own history the potential state precedes

### FORM OVER MATTER IS THE SAME PRIORITY

- Wood does not tell us what a table is; the functional structure does
- Metaphysics VII (Z).17 asks why this matter is a house, and answers with the form
- Form is actuality considered structurally; actuality is form considered modally

### THE MOVER, BOUNDED CORRECTLY

- Pure actuality with no unrealised potentiality; thought thinking itself (noesis noeseos)
- It attracts as an object of desire and thought; it does not push, create or conserve
- Retained only because pure actuality completes the causal and modal system, not as a theology survey

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Aristotle does not refute the Eleatic argument but denies its dichotomy, adding a third ontological status that makes becoming intelligible without creation from nothing.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Change is the actuality of the potential precisely as potential, so becoming is neither a leap from absolute non-being nor the sheer dissolution of stability.**

13

## STAGE 13 COMPARISON, GRADED VERDICT AND THE ANSWER SPINE

- SEPARATED PARADIGM vs IMMANENT ESSENCE
- UNIVERSAL vs INDIVIDUAL
- THE GOOD vs THE UNMOVED MOVER
- DEFEATS SEPARATION, NOT FORM
- STEPHANUS AND BEKKER
- RULING IN LINE ONE
- THE PROBLEM OF UNIVERSALS

**ONE AXIS: is the form inside the thing? Every further contrast follows from the answer** → **PLATO buys stability, objectivity and knowledge, and forfeits causation** → **ARISTOTLE buys causation, unity and generation, and forfeits a clean account of universals at Z.13** → **ROUTE: directive, definition, argument, example, objection, reply, graded verdict - 10, 15 and 20 marks change only the number of items**

### THE MATCHED CONTRASTS

- Location of form: transcendent against immanent. Most real: the universal against the individual (tode ti)
- Knowledge: dialectical grasp against ascent from sense to universal form and causes
- Causation: paradigm and the Good against four causes and internal teleology
- Highest principle: the Form of the Good against the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality

### DIRECTIVE DECODER

- Elucidate means derive; explain the Cave means map it and include the return
- Differentiate means one axis; examine the critique means arguments plus replies
- Four causes means one worked example; actuality means solve Parmenides first
- Substance means the Categories against Z with two named readings; critically evaluate means a ruling in line one

### CITATION AND FINAL TRAPS

- Plato by Stephanus, Aristotle by Bekker; give 'Book VII (Z)' once in both conventions
- Report as testimony: the Third Man name, the intermediates at Met. I.6, the scholastic 'rational animal', Popper 1945
- Never: Forms as concepts in the mind, four causes as agents, the Mover as efficient cause, potentiality as probability

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The dispute is not settled in antiquity but converted into the problem of universals, and every later realism and nominalism debate inherits its terms.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle transforms Plato's insight rather than erasing it, because removing separation solves causation while leaving the intelligibility of form as an unfinished problem.**

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## EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT - ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

- OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH
- THIRD MAN AFTER THE STOCK REGRESS
- FOCAL MEANING OF BEING
- INDIVIDUAL vs SPECIES FORM
- DEGREES OF BEING
- EQUAL MIDDLE SEGMENTS
- ARISTOTLE'S PLATO IS A REPORTED PLATO

### INTERPRETIVE DISPUTES

- Does the Third Man refute all Forms or only a self-predicative version? Vlastos, Fine and developmental readings differ
- How can there be one science of being qua being? The focal-meaning reading refers every sense back to substance
- Is Aristotelian form individual or species-level? Frede-Patzig against Owen, with a mixed reading available

### SOURCE-CRITICAL REFINEMENTS

- Degrees of being: Plato's Line presupposes them and Metaphysics I.9 denies them
- The middle segments of the Line are necessarily equal, a fact Plato never comments on
- Several familiar Platonic doctrines reach us only through Aristotle, who is summarising a view he is about to refute

### CONCEPTUAL LINKS, NOT CURRENT AFFAIRS

- Rationalism inherits and redefines the substance vocabulary; Kant targets both Platonic and Aristotelian metaphysics
- Nyaya-Vaisesika's God as efficient cause is the natural contrast with a mover that acts as a final cause
- Samkhya's doctrine that the effect pre-exists in the cause parallels potentiality, and must not be pushed further

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer and should be used only for a single evaluative clause after the complete core has been written.